Steven R. Brown

| steven.r.brown.tech@gmail.com | **Portfolio:** www.stevenrbrown.org |

EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University — **University Park, PA**
B.S. Cybersecurity Analytics and Operations — May 2025

- Major GPA: 3.83/4.0; Minors: Security Risk Analysis (SRA) and Information Sciences and Technology (IST).
- Awards: Pennsylvania State University Vice Provost Award. Dean's List Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Spring 2024, and Spring 2025.
- Relevant Courses: Malware Analysis, Networking & Telecommunications, Security Analytics Studio, Information Security Management, and Spatial Analysis of Risk.

RELATED TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Digital Cloak LLC — **Stafford, VA**
Technical Intern — June 2024 - August 2024

- Built and operated a T-Pot honeypot platform integrating Suricata and Snort for intrusion detection, and deployed canary tokens to capture and analyze real-world attacker behavior, directly supporting incident visibility and response readiness.
- Deployed and administered a containerized security stack (Docker, Proxmox, Debian 12) including the ELK stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana) for log aggregation and analysis, plus Nagios and Kismet for infrastructure and wireless network monitoring.
- Supported compliance workflows aligned with NIST SP 800, CMMC, Incident Response (IR), and OSINT best practices.
- Designed and trained a locally hosted AI Cybersecurity Compliance Assistant using insights from 150+ regulatory and security documents.

Penn State University College of IST — **University Park, PA**
Learning Assistant (Cyber 262 & IST 456) — January 2023 - December 2024

- Led hands on instruction in network defense, system hardening, and incident response for undergraduate cybersecurity courses.
- Assisted students with Linux systems, virtual machines, and security labs, and collaborated with faculty to refine lab exercises for real-world SOC relevance.

Penn State Homecoming Technology Committee — **University Park, PA**
Technology Captain — Spring 2024 - Fall 2024

- Managed and revamped the Penn State Homecoming website using WordPress and Elementor, keeping it visually appealing and up to date with the latest information and events.

Aquila Digital (aquiladigital.net) — **Akron, OH**
Founder | Freelance Web, App, & IT Services (LLC in progress) — Fall 2023 - Present

- Independently designing and coding client and organizational websites, web, and mobile apps for local businesses and personal contacts to establish a professional portfolio, like Brown Baseball Performance (BBP), using VS Code, Next.js, HTML/JavaScript, and Tailwind CSS.
- Expanding service lines into workflow automation, cybersecurity informed IT support, and technology literacy seminars at local senior living communities.

WORK EXPERIENCE

The LandTek Group — **Long Island, NY**
Turf Installer — July 2025 - January 2026; March 2026 - Present

- Install artificial turf systems for professional and collegiate athletic organizations (NFL, NCAA, FIFA, MLB) and contracted high schools, operating heavy machinery and traveling 100% to job sites nationwide under tight, high-visibility project timelines.

Men's Wearhouse — **State College, PA; Canton, OH**
Store Lead | Sales Associate — May 2022 - May 2025; January - March 2026

- Led daily store operations with manager system authorization, supervised associates, and delivered high-quality customer service while resolving escalated issues.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

TalonForge: — **November 2026 - Present**

- Free, local-first coding and IT-careers platform under Aquila Digital, featuring browser-based labs and SIEM and help-desk job simulators so users can practice real analyst and support workflows without signing up.

QuoteWork: — **Spring 2026 - Present**

- Modular invoice generator for service businesses; the invoice updates live as pricing and add-ons are selected during a client consultation, with options to save/edit a draft or submit a final invoice that is printed or emailed directly to the client.

Finio - Your Finance, Automated: — **Fall 2025 - Present**

- Personal finance budgeting app that captures mobile purchase/charge notifications and logs them directly into a budget in real time, eliminating manual spreadsheet entry; not linked to any bank accounts, keeping financial data private and secure.

GolfCaddie - Your Personal Golf Assistant: — **Fall 2023 - Present**

- AI-driven golf decision assistant built with, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG); recommends club selection in real time from PGA rules, swing data, club-distance yardages, distance to target, and pin location.

CloakAI: — **August 2024**

- Built a locally hosted AI chatbot specializing in cybersecurity compliance and best practices. Integrated 150+ documents covering NIST SP 800, CMMC, IR, and OSINT frameworks. Designed to support analyst decision-making and compliance interpretation without cloud data exposure.

Orange Pi 5 Plus Setup Guide: — **August 2024**

- Documented a full build and hardening guide for a standalone network-monitoring appliance on an Orange Pi 5 Plus: Armbian OS installation, Kismet for wireless packet capture, and Metricbeat feeding an ELK stack for centralized log analysis.

CERTIFICATIONS

Fortinet Training Institute: Introduction to the Threat Landscape 3.0, Getting Started in Cybersecurity 3.0. — **December 2025**
NSA IST Certification — **May 2025**
DOD Mandatory Controlled Unclassified Information Training (CUI) — **June 2024**
LinkedIn Learning Certifications: — **Fall/Spring 2023**

- Cybersecurity Awareness: Cloud Security, Cybersecurity Awareness: Cybersecurity Terminology, Cybersecurity: Key Policies and Resources.

SKILLS

Cybersecurity & Systems: Incident response; log and network traffic analysis (ELK stack, Suricata, Snort); malware analysis fundamentals; network and endpoint security; SIEM (Splunk, ELK); Linux (Ubuntu, Debian, Raspbian); virtual machine deployment and management; security automation and workflow integration.
Programming Languages: Developed applications and websites using Java, JavaScript, Python, C#, SQL, HTML/CSS, and Tailwind.
Technical Tools & Frameworks: Experienced with VS Code, IntelliJ, WordPress, Next.js, .NET, Vercel; LLM integration, RAG, prompt engineering, document ingestion pipelines, and vector search.